ALDRIC — THE LAST DANCE OF SHADOWS

[Intro – Distant music box, distorted waltz]

Come, little soul
Come, take my hand
We have a place
In a promised land

Close your eyes
Forget the pain
The ones you lost
Will live again

[Verse 1 – Dark, theatrical vocals]

Candles burn and faces smile
Welcome to our house of lies
Kneel before the painted saint
Trade your tears for sweet escape

Mother's voice and father's eyes
Every promise, dressed in white
Sign your name and close the door
You won't need your heart no more

[Pre-Chorus – Metallic percussion builds]

One more prayer
One more lie
One more soul

We sacrifice

[Chorus – Heavy industrial beat, sinister melody]

Dance, dance, dance in the dead of night
We sell you heaven, we steal your light
Give us your sorrow, give us your name
Nothing is lost if you worship the pain

Smile, little sinner, the end is near
The voice you love is all you hear
But when the music fades away
Who's left to save you from the grave?

[Verse 2 – Slower, darker]

I wore the dark to hide my face
I called my guilt a sacred grace
I watched the innocent believe
In every lie I couldn't leave

I thought that silence made me strong
I knew the truth all along
Now every ghost remembers me
And none of them will set me free

[Pre-Chorus – Whispered, tense]

One more name
One more scar
Tell me, how

Did I fall so far?

[Chorus – Full orchestral-industrial impact]

Dance, dance, dance in the dead of night
We sell you heaven, we steal your light
Give us your sorrow, give us your name
Nothing is lost if you worship the pain

Smile, little sinner, the end is near
The voice you love is all you hear
But when the music fades away
Who's left to save you from the grave?

[Bridge – Waltz slows, piano and strings]

I never asked to be forgiven
I only wished to stop the bleeding
If I could take back every breath
I'd trade my life to undo death

I hear them calling through the wall
The names I buried, one and all
No prayer can change what I have done
No shadow hides me from the sun

[Final Chorus – Chaotic, tragic climax]

Dance, dance, dance, the curtains fall
No god will answer when you call
The candles die, the choir cries

The truth is waiting in your eyes

No more promises, no more lies

No resurrection, no disguise

When all the music fades away

We face the souls we betrayed

[Outro – Music box stops abruptly]

The dance is over...

The lights are gone...

And in the silence...

I remain.

[End]